

2.8d

intelligence & achievement

Group Differences & Question of Bias

What's int. difference between genders?

Men self-estimate own int. higher than women do

→ Just false perception that men smarter than women

Basically no difference in int. between genders

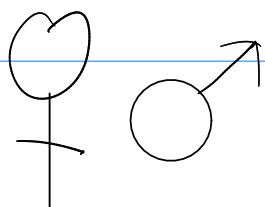
Where both girls & boys are educated, girls tend to outpace boys in spelling, verbal fluency, reading & locating objects.

They're better emotion detectors & more sensitive to touch, taste & color

More variation in male mental abilities than females

Males outnumber females in both extremes of int.

In Asia and Russia, where there were numerous socialist nations like USSR & Mao's China that rapidly spearheaded women's rights far ahead of the west, teen girls outperform boys in an international science exam, but in the west, boys score higher.



Gender-Equality $\uparrow$ $\rightarrow$ Gender-math-gap $\downarrow$

int. is dependant on cultural expectations & opportunities

What are the differences between racial & ethnic groups?

- racial & ethnic groups mostly overlap, but differ in avg int. test scores.
- High-scoring people are more likely to attain higher levels of education & income

Settler New-Zealanders outscore indigenous Maori
Colonizer "Israelis" outscore indigenous palestinians living within the zionist entity
White Americans out score black americans.

Oppressors tend to outscore the oppressed, possibly due to their better socioeconomic status

Hereditly contributes to individual differences, but group differences in a heritable trait are environmental

Race is primarily a social category without well-defined physical boundaries

gen-to-gen diff in scores: today's better fed, educated & more
test prepared populations exceed those of the 1930s

income inequality is $\uparrow$ $\rightarrow$ access to college education is $\downarrow$

Grades may reflect conscientiousness rather than competence

Are intelligence tests biased?

Scientific definition of bias: whether test predicts future
behavior for all groups, not just for some.

By this definition, int. tests are not biased.

But, in everyday language, we say a test is biased
if it's unfair, and int. tests are.

test scores influenced by taker's developed abilities,
which reflect their education & cultural experiences

these tests are a vehicle for discrimination

For this reason, many recommend creating culture-neutral questions

Today's standardized tests are "rigorously reviewed" to try to minimize
cultural bias (and they fail)

test proponents say not to blame a measuring stick

Expectations

Expectations can add bias.

Stereotype threat: marginalized groups may internalize negative stereotypes about them, creating doubts that hijack int. skills

Stereotype lift: individuals from stereotypically advantaged groups perform better due to better expectations

Personal connection

I recently took the WAIS-IV, & I received a PSIQ of 130. However, I strongly feel that these tests are terrible at what they try to assess, & what they try to assess is fundamentally unassessable.

MCQ

1. d 2. a 3. c 4. c 5. b 6. a